

Upendra Kumar

Azure Delivery Architect | Presales-to-Delivery Cloud & AI Transformation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Azure delivery architect with 20 years designing enterprise cloud transformation, with direct experience partnering with presales teams to shape technical solutions, estimates, and business cases while retaining accountability for delivery. Translates Azure architecture decisions, landing zones, migration, and security, into client-ready business cases and executive recommendations, backed by a track record of turning discovery and assessment engagements into funded, signed delivery scope. Combines deep hands-on Azure delivery credentials (Solutions Architect Expert, Cybersecurity Architect Expert, TOGAF 10) with the opportunity-to-delivery continuity a presales architect seat requires.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Presales Partnership & Solutioning: partners with presales teams on technical solutions, estimates, and business cases; supports proposals, technical workshops, and solution defense from opportunity qualification through delivery.

TCO & Business Case Development: discovery-to-business-case ownership, cost/benefit/risk analysis that converts technical assessments into funded delivery phases.

Executive & Stakeholder Engagement: business case presentation to senior stakeholders, translating architecture trade-offs into cost, risk, scope, and timeline recommendations.

Azure Landing Zones (CAF/ALZ): management groups, policy/RBAC, hub-spoke networking, private connectivity, DNS, WAF/firewall/NVA patterns.

Cloud Migration Strategy: readiness assessment, dependency mapping, wave planning, cutover governance, Azure Migrate/ASR.

Security & Identity: Zero Trust, privileged access, baseline hardening, logging/monitoring, threat modeling.

Delivery Leadership: mentoring 15+ architects and engineers, standardizing delivery patterns adopted across teams.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Professional Services Delivery Architect | Rackspace Technology India (Remote) 2022 – 2026

- Partnered closely with presales teams to shape technical solutions, estimates, delivery approaches, and business cases for enterprise Azure transformation opportunities, translating architecture choices into cost, risk, scope, and timeline recommendations for senior stakeholders, while retaining accountability for subsequent delivery.
- Owned assessment-to-business-case engagements, including a 475-server, 126-application financial services estate, producing readiness, TCO, risk, and migration analysis that led directly to a funded landing zone and migration program.
- Led end-to-end Azure landing zone and migration engagements across networking, identity, security, and governance using CAF/ALZ, spanning multi-subscription, multi-region estates of 50-4,000 workloads, including a 118-server migration for a financial services regulator.
- Authored HLD/LLD design patterns for private connectivity, WAF/App Gateway, APIM, AKS, Key Vault, and baseline logging/monitoring, converted into reusable Terraform modules by delivery engineering teams; supported proposals, technical workshops, and solution defense in the absence of a dedicated solutioning function, ensuring continuity from opportunity qualification through implementation.
- Mentored 15+ architects and engineers, standardizing solution and delivery patterns across engagements.

Sr. Infra Architect | Cognizant, Noida, India 2022

- Contributed to infrastructure and cloud architecture workstreams: discovery, solution validation, HLD/LLD inputs.
- Supported transition planning and operational readiness for delivery handover.

Professional Services Delivery Architect | Rackspace Technology, Gurugram, India 2020 – 2022

- Delivered Azure foundation and migration architecture artifacts for regulated and enterprise clients.
- Defined repeatable secure baseline patterns across governance (management groups, RBAC, policy) and networking (hub-spoke, private access, DNS).

Cloud Architect, Tech Lead | Accenture, Gurugram, India 2019 – 2020

- Azure SME and tech lead for BFSI clients, guiding discovery through target architecture, build, and go-live; led a delivery team of 15 engineers with formal performance and appraisal ownership.
- Designed Azure landing-zone foundations across identity, networking, security, and governance.

Cloud Consultant | HCL Technologies, Noida, India 2014 – 2019

- Delivered modernization and migration planning for enterprise workloads, low-risk cutover approaches.
- People manager for a team of 15 direct reports; mentored early-career engineers.

System Engineer | Atos IT Solutions / Siemens IT Solutions, Kolkata, India 2009 – 2014

- Infrastructure engineering and operational support for enterprise systems, building foundational systems administration experience.
- Site Engineer, Sales & Support Engineer, Project Engineer | Commtel Networks / Fastech** 2006 – 2009
Telecommunications / Arya Omnitalk Wireless Solutions, India
- Telecom field engineering and technical presales: SDH/PDH systems installation, telecom test instrument presales/support, and automatic vehicle classification systems.

EDUCATION

PGDM, Operations Management | Institute of Management Technology, Ghaziabad, India | 2023–2024
B.E., Electronics and Communication Engineering | Rajiv Gandhi Prodyogiki Vishwavidyalaya, India | 2002–2006

CERTIFICATIONS

- 🏆 **Microsoft Certified:** Azure Solutions Architect Expert, Cybersecurity Architect Expert, DevOps Engineer Expert
- 🏆 **TOGAF 10 Practitioner** (Enterprise Architecture)
- 🏆 **Google Cloud Certified:** Professional Cloud Architect, Generative AI Leader
- 🏆 **Aviatrix Certified Multicloud Network Associate** (ACMNA)

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

AI Compliance & Governance framework: governance framework for enterprise AI platforms on Azure AI Foundry.

Enterprise Landing Zones: production-ready Azure foundation, 40% deployment time reduction.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- 🏆 **Rackspace Fanatical Learner:** 199+ hours upskilling (2025).
- 🏆 **Champagne Spot Award:** Atos, for proactive behaviour.
- 🏆 **Merit Reward and Outstanding Performance Award:** Siemens IT Solutions.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.